

Telangana Digital Workforce Repository

Digitising the Service Records of 10 Lakh Government Employees Across 29 Departments

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~10 Lakh Total Employees Mapped	29 Departments Covered	199 Heads of Department	61% Operational Strength
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◆ THE PROBLEM — A ₹ BILLION BLIND SPOT

In 2019, the Government of Telangana faced an extraordinary situation: it did not know — with any confidence — exactly how many people were on its payroll.

Salary disbursements across 29 departments were processed monthly, but the underlying service records were fragmented, paper-based, or maintained inconsistently across district offices, zonal units, and directorate headquarters. The Finance Department had no consolidated, real-time picture of its workforce.

The consequences were direct and measurable:

- Employees drew salaries that were never audited or cross-verified
- Vacancy lists were guesswork — departments could not accurately plan recruitment
- Retirement waves, promotion cycles, and leave-driven gaps were invisible to planners
- Budget allocations for personnel expenditure were based on estimates, not actuals

The Finance Department issued a directive: all 199 Head of Departments must upload verified cadre strength to the IFMIS Portal by a firm deadline. Departments that failed to comply would be blocked from processing that month's salary.

◆ THE PROJECT — SIX MONTHS IN THE ENGINE ROOM OF GOVERNMENT

A cross-functional team of 12 specialists was assembled under the Finance Secretariat to drive the data collection, verification, and digitisation effort. The project ran for six to seven months and operated at the highest levels of state government — with weekly updates flowing to the Chief Minister, Chief Secretary, Finance Minister, and Principal Secretary.

Coordination was led in close partnership with the Finance Secretary. Progress was tracked department-by-department. Delays triggered direct intervention from the Secretariat.

Sriharika's Portfolio: Health, PRRD, and Education

Three of the largest and most complex departments were assigned to Sriharika — chosen because of their scale, the heterogeneity of their workforce categories, and the critical importance of their data to state-level policy:

 Medical & Health 52,000+ personnel. Doctors, nurses, paramedics, contract medical officers, and outsourced support staff across district hospitals, PHCs, and health centres.	 PR&RD Panchayat Raj & Rural Development — spanning village-level workers, field officers, honorary gram panchayat staff, and outsourced implementation personnel.	 Education The largest employer in the state — 1.13 lakh personnel including SGT teachers, Headmasters, contract lecturers, mid-day meal workers, and non-teaching staff.
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◆ WHAT WAS BUILT — A LIVING WORKFORCE INTELLIGENCE SYSTEM

For each department, a comprehensive employee registry was constructed and uploaded to IFMIS. Each record captured:

Data Field	Why It Mattered
Employee Name & ID	Enabled unique identification across departments, eliminating duplicates
Pay Range / Pay Scale	Established salary liability and supported budget forecasting
Gender (M/F)	Enabled gender-disaggregated reporting for HR planning and schemes
Employment Category	Regular / Contract / Honorary / Outsourced — each with distinct legal status and pay rules
Designation & Grade	Mapped to sanctioned posts for vacancy calculation
Retirement Date	Enabled 2–5 year recruitment pipeline planning per department
Promotion Eligibility	Identified bottlenecks in cadre progression
Leave & Absence Status	Captured actual availability vs. nominal headcount

Employee Categories Tracked

Each employee record was classified into one of five workforce categories — a distinction that carries significant policy implications for salary liability, benefit entitlements, and long-term headcount planning:

- Regular — Permanent employees with full government pay scales and service protections
- Contract — Fixed-term staff on negotiated terms, typically specialists or seasonal roles
- Honorary — Volunteers or part-time appointees serving without standard remuneration
- Outsourced — Staff provided by third-party agencies; headcount counted but budget managed differently
- On Leave / Other — Employees on extended leave, deputation, or suspended pending enquiry

◆ WHAT THE DATA REVEALED

The digitisation effort did more than clean up payroll records — it exposed structural patterns that had never been visible at the state level:

 The 61% Utilisation Gap State departments were operating at an average of just 61% of their sanctioned strength — meaning roughly 1 in 3 approved posts was unfilled. This was not known with precision until the data was consolidated.	 Workforce Mix Imbalance Of approximately 10 lakh total personnel, 5.21 lakh were regular employees and 4.93 lakh were on temporary, contract, or outsourced terms — a near 50-50 split that raised critical questions about service continuity.
 Retirement Wave Visibility With date-of-birth and service entry records now digitised, the system could project retirement timelines — giving departments the lead time to plan recruitment and prevent sudden expertise gaps.	 Health Sector Complexity Health alone had 52,000+ staff spanning five categories across hundreds of facilities. Mapping this accurately required direct interaction with department secretaries and district-level reconciliation.

◆ IMPACT — FROM DATA CHAOS TO POLICY INTELLIGENCE

The project delivered a single source of truth for Telangana's workforce — a foundation for every HR, budget, and recruitment decision made at the state level thereafter.

- Accurate vacancy lists generated for the first time — enabling targeted recruitment drives
- Salary liability for temporary and contract staff quantified accurately, reducing payroll leakage
- Promotion and retirement pipelines made visible 2–3 years ahead for planning purposes
- IFMIS compliance enforced as a hard requirement — departments could not draw salaries without verified records
- Foundation laid for ongoing workforce analytics — the system continued to evolve post-project

Stakeholder Context

Weekly status updates were shared with the Chief Minister's office, the Chief Secretary, and the Finance Minister. Progress was scrutinized at the highest levels because the outcome directly affected the state's ability to manage its largest category of public expenditure — its people.

◆ SKILLS DEMONSTRATED

Statistical Data Management Designing and maintaining large-scale employee registries with multi-dimensional attributes across heterogeneous workforce categories.	Stakeholder Management Direct coordination with Department Secretaries, district officers, and senior Finance Secretariat officials over a 6–7 month live project.	Predictive HR Analytics Converting raw headcount data into forward-looking insights on vacancies, retirements, and promotion pipelines — the foundation of evidence-based recruitment policy.
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